Escalate five open questions before a mandate decision

Independent institutional consultant-review case, 27 October 2026. Catalogue 16: one hypothetical UK pension client. The US Global Bond Fund is a public-information proxy, not a UK-approved mandate or an actual client relationship.

Review judgement

Escalate. Class I beat the Bloomberg Global Aggregate by 18bp over the quarter to 30 June 2026 but lagged by 51bp over one year. The three-year annualised gap was -13bp and the five-year gap -46bp. Positive quarterly commentary cannot establish persistent net outperformance. These gaps are arithmetic differences between same-horizon quoted returns, not a statistically estimated alpha.

Process questions

The fund held 31.9% corporates against 18.4% in the index: an active weight of 13.5 percentage points. Treasuries were 13.0 points underweight. These exposures are consistent with an active spread-sector approach; they do not prove sources of return. The commentary identifies credit allocation as a contributor but does not publish a numerical attribution table. Request that table rather than manufacture a bridge.

Consultant workflow

Eight sample questions are recorded: three supported and five open. Suggested role owners and a five-day deadline are illustrative. The five gaps cover numerical attribution, GBP-hedged mandate terms, pension vehicle access, security-level process evidence and a Class R ticker inconsistency between the factsheet header and table. No requests were sent, no meeting occurred and no responses are claimed.

The quarter and YTD are cumulative returns; longer periods are annualised. All are the same 30 June 2026 endpoint. Net expenses are not deducted again from these published returns. Fund sectors sum to 100%; benchmark weights sum to 99.9% due to source rounding, leaving a 0.1pp residual. dash for benchmark cash is interpreted as zero and documented. Sample statuses can be changed in Excel and dashboard counts update.

Meeting brief

Ask the investment team why longer-horizon excess returns remain negative despite the quarter's credit contribution. Ask how FX and duration would differ in a GBP-hedged mandate. Request exact share-class and vehicle identifiers before circulating performance. Keep the case unapproved until the missing mandate-specific evidence is obtained.

Limits

A dated aggregate snapshot cannot establish security selection, turnover decisions, risk-adjusted skill or client suitability. This case uses public data and hypothetical workflow records; it was built with Codex assistance. It is not a record of actual consultant servicing.

Sources: archived factsheet pages 1–2 and commentary pages 1–2; URLs in data/sources.json. Source and assumption tags are described in assumptions.py. Python/Excel parity and period checks are in tests.